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The winner will walk away with a cheque of USD 2.34 million, marking the first time that the men's and women's teams will receive equal rewards for their triumphs.



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2024 campaign will offer a shot at redemption.

In the eight T20Is the Windies have played this year, they have won six. However, these matches have only involved two nations — Pakistan and Sri Lanka — both of which have structural flaws in their squads.

The standout player is undoubtedly allrounder and skipper Hayley Matthews, who has had an enviably successful lead-up to the World Cup with both bat and ball. However, all eyes will be on former captain Deandra Dottin, who came out of retirement and has slotted herself back into the mix.

The West Indies will fare better if the onus isn't placed on one player to carry the team, even if it is someone as well-rounded as Matthews. That

strategy didn't work with Dottin and Stafanie Taylor, and will likely set it up for failure if it's relied upon again.

Another team undergoing a metamorphosis is Pakistan. With new captain Fatima Sana at the helm, the side is still trying to gel as a unit and stitch together coordinated performances to move the team's cause forward.

In the 15 T20Is played this year, the Women in Green have triumphed just four times. While there have been plenty of close games, the team's long-standing inability to close out matches has haunted it so far this year.

A World Cup campaign without off-field chatter has become an anomaly for Pakistan, with the issue of denied daily allowances

dominating headlines before its last international assignment against South Africa ahead of the UAE trip.

On the field, the cricket itself was quite encouraging against the Proteas. With the likes of Muneeba Ali and Sidra Ameen finding form, and the total of 181 in the second fixture boosting confidence, Pakistan can be optimistic. Sadia Iqbal had a memorable series, taking six wickets, and even former skipper Nida Dar bowled economically in key stages.

Despite this, Pakistan needs to work on plenty of basics, and with a leader learning on the job, the think tank will have its work cut out for this tournament.

#### Slow and steady

South Africa has been approaching the world event with a